

Hyunah Ahn

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Second Language Studies
University of Hawaii at Manoa (UHM), Honolulu, Hawaii

Doctoral studies in English Language & Literature
Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea

M.A. in TESOL
Michigan State University, East Lansing, Michigan

B.A. in English Language and Literature (Minor: Psychology)
Ajou University, Suwon, Korea

EMPLOYMENT

2022-present Department of English Language and Literature, Kunsan National University
2026-present: Associate Professor
2025-present: Department Chair
2022-2026: Assistant Professor

2017-2022 Lecturer
Department of English Language and Literature, Seoul National University (2017-2022)
Department of English Language and Literature, Korea University (Winter 2020)
Dasan University College, Ajou University, Suwon, Korea (AY2018, Fall 2008)
Kyonggi University, Suwon, Korea (Fall 2017)

2010-2017 Graduate Assistant
University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI, USA

GRANTS

2026-2028 NRF Research Grant (# 2026S1A5A80083771140182064070101)
New Researcher Research Grant (40 million Korean won)
“Korean as a foreign/heritage language sentence processing”
National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea

2022 New Faculty Research Grant
“The acquisition of psych-predicates in Korean as a second language”
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea

2021 NRF Research Grant (# 2021S1A5B5A17048833)
Humanities and Social Sciences Academic Research Professor (14 million Korean won)
“The resolution of null arguments in Korean as a second language”
National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea

- 2020 NRF Research Grant (# 2020S1A5B5A17089402)
 Humanities and Social Sciences Academic Research Professor (14 million Korean won)
 “The effect of non-linguistic information in L2 processing of active and passive constructions”
 National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea
- 2019 NRF Research Grant (# 2019S1A5B5A07111230)
 Research fund for Next Generation Researchers (14 million Korean won)
 “An investigation of exemplar-based language learning using psychological predicates in Korean”
 National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea
- 2018 NRF Research Grant (# 2018S1A5B5A07071643)
 Research fund for Next Generation Researchers (14 million Korean won)
 “The integration of multiple types of information in real-time second language processing”
 National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea
- 2015 East-West Center Field Research Grant
 Research fund for doctoral dissertation; Merit-based competition
 East-West Center, Honolulu, HI
- 2015 *Language Learning* Dissertation Grant
 Merit-based competition hosted by *Language Learning* (Wiley)
 The *Language Learning* Dissertation Grant Program

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Journals

- Ahn, H. (2025). Null pronoun interpretation probed via thematic role ambiguity: A case in Korean. *Linguistics Vanguard*, 11(1), 231-246. <https://doi.org/10.1515/lingvan-2025-0065>
- Ahn, H. (2025). From items to morphemes: A comparative Rasch analysis of Korean C-test scoring. *Foreign Languages Education*, 26(4), 23-44. <http://dx.doi.org/10.15334/FLE.2025.32.3.93>
- Ahn, H & Mariano, G. (2024). The morphological distribution of English two-place psych-predicates in children’s language input. *Studies in English Language & Literature*, 50(4). <https://dx.doi.org/10.21559/aellk.2024.50.4.011>
- Ahn, H. (2024). The argument drop patterns of the psych-predicate *mwusep-* in spoken, written, and messenger corpora. *Studies in English Language & Literature*, 50(2), 153-173. <https://dx.doi.org/10.21559/aellk.2024.50.2.008>
- Ahn, H. & Song, M.-J. (2023). L1 Korean speakers’ definiteness processing in L2 English: A visual world paradigm eye-tracking study. *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*, 26(3), 556-569. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1366728922000840> (ISSN: 1366-7289, On-line ISSN: 1469-1841)
- Ahn, H. (2022). L2 Processing of linguistic and non-linguistic information: L2 speakers use definiteness if real-world knowledge is unusable. *Studies in Second Language Acquisition*, 44(2), 507-535. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0272263121000322> (ISSN: 0272-2631; On-line ISSN: 1470-1545)

- Ahn, H. (2021). From Interlanguage grammar to target grammar in L2 processing of definiteness as uniqueness. *Second Language Research*, 37(1), 91-119. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0267658319868003> (ISSN: 0267-6583)
- Ahn, H. (2020). L2 Korean speakers' thematic role resolution in a psych-predicate construction. *Language Research*, 56(2), 141-165. <https://doi.org/10.30961/lr.2020.56.2.141>
- Ahn, H. (2018). Prosody, syntax, and discourse: A three-way interaction. *Korean Journal of Linguistics*, 43(1), 73-100. <https://www.dbpia.co.kr/Article/NODE07449324> (ISSN:1229-4039)
- Ahn, H. (2017). The prosodic resolution of syntactic/semantic ambiguity: An exemplar-based account. *Language Research*, 53(3), 501-524. <https://doi.org/10.30961/lr.2017.53.3.501> (pISSN: 0254-5574)

Doctoral Dissertation

- Ahn, H. (2017). *The integration of linguistic and non-linguistic information in L2 sentence processing* (Doctoral dissertation). University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI. Available from ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global (ProQuest document ID: 1953257187). (ISBN: 978-0-35526-430-2)

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

- Ahn, H. (2016). Reference in discourse: The case of L2 and heritage Korean. In M. Kenstowicz, T. Levin, & R. Masuda (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 23rd Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference*. Stanford: CSLI Publications.(ISBN: 978-1-57586-752-6; 978-1-57586-841-7) <https://web.stanford.edu/group/cslipublications/cslipublications/site/9781575867526.shtml>
- Ahn, H. (2012). Prosodic boundaries and null arguments in L2 Korean. In A. K. Biller, E. Y. Chung, & A. E. Kimball (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 36th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.(ISBN: 978-1-57473-075-3; 978-1-57473-175-0) <http://www.cascadilla.com/bucl36toc.html>

Edited Books

- Ahn, H., Clements, N., Lim, H., Lim, J., & Park, Y. (2020). *New Teachers' Guidebook*. Faculty of Liberal Education. Seoul National University.
- Ahn, H., & Vidal, M. (2012). *Proceedings of the 16th Annual College of Languages, Linguistics and Literature Graduate Student Conference*, University of Hawaii at Manoa <http://hdl.handle.net/10125/14565>

PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

- Ahn, H. (2026). International Circle of Korean Linguistics 2026 Conference:
“The Effect of Verb Semantics on the Interpretation of (C)overt Pronoun Thematic Roles”
University of Sheffield, UK, July 1

- Ahn, H. (2026). The Spring Conference of the Association of English Language and Literature of Korea (AELLK): “Proto-Patient Bias and Predictive Discourse Processing in Korean”
Jeonbuk National University, Gunsan, Korea, May 30
- Ahn, H. (2024). The Fall Conference of AELLK:
“The good-enough processing of English psych-verbs.”
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea, November 2
- Ahn, H. & Mariano, G. (2024). The Spring Conference of AELLK:
“The distribution of past and present participial forms of psych-verbs in English.”
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea, June 1
- Ahn, H. (2023). The Fall Conference of AELLK:
“L2 processing of morphological distinction in English psych-verbs”
Jeonbuk National University, Jeonju, Korea, November 4
- Ahn, H. (2022). The Joint Fall Conference of the English Linguistics Society of Korea and The Discourse and Cognitive Linguistics Society of Korea:
“Resolving ambiguity in a null argument construction with two-place psych-predicates”
Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, November 5
- Ahn, H. (2022). The 2022 Seoul International Conference on Linguistics:
“The thematic role interpretation of overt NPs in a null argument construction”
Virtual online conference, August 11
- Ahn, H. & Song, M. (2019). Second Language Research Forum 2019:
“The role of definiteness in predictive L2 sentence processing: An eye-tracking study”
Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI, September 21
- Ahn, H. (2018). 2018 SNU International Conference on Linguistics:
“Simultaneous processing of grammar and world knowledge in second language”
Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea, June 15
- Ahn, H. (2017). The 2017 Fall Conference of the Linguistic Society of Korea :
“Prosody, syntax, and discourse: An exemplar-based account of the interface.”
Seoul National University. Seoul, Korea, November 24
- Ahn, H. (2016). The 41st Boston University Conference on Language Development:
“The integration of linguistic and non-linguistic information in L2 processing”
Boston, MA, November 4
- Ahn, H. (2016). The 35th Second Language Research Forum:
“The incremental processing of linguistic vs. non-linguistic information in L2”
Columbia University, New York, NY, September 23
- Ahn, H. (2015). International Circle of Korean Linguistics / Harvard International Symposium on Korean Linguistics Joint Conference:
“The disambiguating effect of intermediate phrases (ip) in Korean prosody and discourse”
University of Chicago, Chicago, IL, July 25
- Ahn, H. (2013). The 23rd Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference:
“The accessibility and the form of a referent in discourse: The case of L2 and Heritage Korean”
Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston, MA, October 11

- Ahn, H. (2013). The 35th Language Testing Research Colloquium:
 “Morpheme-by-morpheme Rasch analysis of a Korean C-test as a diagnostic tool”
 Seoul, Korea, July 4
- Ahn, H. (2013). The 12th Generative Approaches to Second Language Acquisition Conference:
 “Topicality and argument drop patterns in L2 Korean and Heritage Korean”
 University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, April 27
- Ahn, H. (2011). The 36th Boston University Conference on Language Development:
 “The role of prosody in thematic role disambiguation in L2 Korean”
 Boston, MA, November 5
- Ahn, H. (2010). American Association of Applied Linguistics (AAAL):
 “Causes of English article misuse: A case of Korean EFL learners”
 Atlanta, GA, March 6

Poster Presentations

- Ahn, H. (2018). The 92nd Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America:
 “The role of real-world knowledge in second language sentence processing.”
 Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4
- Ahn, H. (2016). The 5th Joint Meeting of the Acoustic Society of America and the Acoustic Society of Japan: “Two types of intermediate phrases (ip) in Korean”
 Honolulu, HI, December 2
- Ahn, H. (2016). The 29th Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing:
 “Slow NOT Shallow Processing of (In)definiteness in L2 English”
 University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, March 5
- Ahn, H. (2015). Chuo University-University of Hawaii at Manoa Student Conference on Linguistics, Psycholinguistics, and Second Language Acquisition:
 “The processing and accommodation of definiteness as uniqueness in L2 English”
 University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI, September 15
- Ahn, H. (2014). The 39th Boston University Conference on Language Development:
 “Definiteness as uniqueness in L2 English article use” Boston, MA, November 8
- Ahn, H. (2012). The 163th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America:
 “Boundary tones in comprehension & production of a pro-drop language: The case of Korean”
 Hong Kong, May 18
- Ahn, H. (2011). The 21st Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference:
 “The role of prosody in thematic role disambiguation in Korean”
 Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea, October 21
- Ahn, H. (2011). Experimental and Theoretical Advances in Prosody (ETAP):
 “Intonational Phrase boundary tones and argument drop patterns in Korean”
 McGill University, Montreal, Canada, September 24
- Ahn, H. (2009). Second Language Research Forum (SLRF):
 “Interlanguage performance of trainees in an in-service teacher training program in Korea: Task type variability in English article use”
 Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI, October 31

Invited Talks

2018 The 104th Department of English Language and Literature Colloquium

“Processing language with non-linguistic information”

Department of English Language and Literature, Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea,
April 27

2016 Invited speaker for the Department of Linguistics Colloquium

“The Integration of linguistic and non-Linguistic information in L2 sentence processing”

California State University at Fresno, CA, February 29

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **Kunsan National University** (S2022-present)

- Undergraduate: Computation & English Linguistics, English Phonetics & Phonology, English Listening Practice, Practical English, English 1, English 2

- Graduate: Research Methods in English Linguistics, Studies in Applied Linguistics 1, 2, English Phonetics & Phonology

- **Seoul National University** (F2017-F2021)

- Undergraduate: Modern Society and Global Language; Advanced English: Culture and Society, Exploring Film; College English 1, 2; English Foundations

- Graduate: Seminar in Applied Linguistics; Research Methods in English Linguistics

- **Korea University**: Psycholinguistics (W2020)

- **Ajou University**

- English 2(F2008, AY2018), Practical English Grammar (F2018)

- In-service Teacher Training Program, College of Education (2007-2010)

- **Kyonggi University**: Teaching Methods of L2 English Writing (F2017)

- **University of Hawaii at Manoa** (F2010 - S2017)

- Undergraduate: Second Language Acquisition, Introduction to Linguistics, English Phonology

- Language Programs: Hawaii English Language Program, English Language Institute, Korean Language Flagship Center

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Spring 2011 Teachers' Online Resource Room improvement project

English Language Institute, University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI

2010 - 2011 Head Graduate Assistant for the phonetics lab

Language Analysis & Experimentation Labs at University of Hawaii at Manoa

2009 - 2010 Coordinator for Monthly TEPS (Test of English Proficiency by Seoul National University) test-item writers

2009 Assistant Researcher for iTEPS (Internet-based TEPS) and SNULT (Seoul National University Language Test)

2008 - 2010 Teaching Assistantship

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2026 Teaching Method Workshop: Chatbot Creation for Classes
Higher Education Training Institute, Jeju, Korea, July 27-29

2023 Understanding Principles and Techniques in College Student Counseling
Higher Education Training Institute, Online Workshop

2019 Team-Based Learning
Center for Teaching and Learning, Seoul National University

2019 Student Counseling Workshop
Center for Teaching and Learning, Seoul National University

2016 SLS B.A. program curriculum mapping workshop
Department of Second Language Studies, University of Hawaii at Manoa

2015 SLS B.A. program outcomes assessment workshop
Department of Second Language Studies, University of Hawaii at Manoa

2012 Summer workshop on computational linguistics
Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea

2011 Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute
University of Colorado, Boulder, CO

SERVICE

Academic Services

Journal Reviews

Studies in Second Language Acquisition (Cambridge University Press; 2020, 2025)

Language & Cognition (Cambridge University Press, 2025)

International Journal of Applied Linguistics (Wiley, 2025)

Second Language Research (Sage; 2018-present)

Lingua (Elsevier; 2024)

Language Acquisition (Taylor & Francis; 2024)

Canadian Journal of Linguistics (Cambridge University Press; 2024)

Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance (APA; 2023)

Bilingualism: Language and Cognition (Cambridge University Press; 2021-2022)

Discourse and Cognition (The Discourse and Cognitive Linguistics Society of Korea; 2021)

International Review of Applied Linguistics in Language Teaching (De Gruyter; 2020)

Southern Journal of Linguistics (Southeastern Conference on Linguistics; 2020)

Language Research (Seoul National University Language Education Institute; 2018-2019)

Other academic services

- 2022 - present Session chair and discussant for the Association of English Language and Literature in Korea
- 2016 Organizing committee member for The Workshop on Experimental Approaches to East Asian Linguistics, University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI
- 2015 Volunteer for the 4th International Conference on Language Documentation and Conservation, Honolulu, HI
- 2013 - 2016 Volunteer for East-West Center International Graduate Student Conferences, East-West Center, Honolulu, HI
- 2012 - 2016 Copy editor for *Reading in a Foreign Language*, 24(1)-26(1); R. Day & T. Hudson, editors, National Foreign Language Resource Center, Honolulu, HI
- 2012 - 2015 Workshops for acoustic phonetics on formant analysis using Praat
Department of Second Language Studies, University of Hawaii at Manoa
- 2010 Organizing committee member for the Korean Association of Teachers of English(KATE) International Conference at Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea

Administrative Services

- 2023-2025 Director of the College English Program
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea
- 2022-2024 Member of gender equality committee
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea

Educational Services

- 2021 Instructor of Pre-College Program for incoming freshmen at Seoul National University
- 2019 Writer of New Teachers' Guidebook for the College English Program at Seoul National University

LANGUAGE

Natural Languages

Korean (Native); English (Native-like); German (Advanced reading); Japanese (Basic)

Computer Languages & Programs

R, LaTeX, HTML, Python, Matlab, JavaScript
E-Prime, PsychoPy, SMI eye-tracking system, Praat, PennController for IBEX